

Let's not forget some of the other great designs in the K4 Cipher. When you consider it all together it is mindboggling to imagine how it could have all been put together in one single compact 97 letter (and occasionally one ?) cryptogram.

K4s Cloak of Innocence. A cover story as a transcript of ham radio banter.

....OB, K, RU, O OXO (..Old Boy, Over, Receiving You, OXO (All Band Transmitter)...SS SS (Sweepstakes/radio relays run by ARRL in Newington, CT just up the road from Berlin, ZZ (Zulu Zulu Greenwich Mean/Meridian Time x2: Meriden just down the road from Berlin, Greenwich a little further SE)... QSJ QSS (Q-code banter).. K C AR (Over, Correct, End-of-message). This does not mean important messages might not be hidden in the Qcodes.

Text Shapes

Clandestine communications have often relied on arranging cipher text in shapes and reversing flow patterns to keep censors and counterintelligence clueless. Code words and enciphered letters often need to be put into normal correspondence, and deliver critical information without anyone noticing they are there. This is a very interesting field at the intersection of clandestine operations, cryptology and steganography. When you rely on the shaping of text to deliver messages, all kinds of things can happen and various seemingly interesting text strings can appear. This is not necessarily a problem if an operative knows *exactly* where a code is to appear. But otherwise it is important to rely on things like "adjacent repeats". So a text shape with multiple symmetric adjacent repeats can be an interesting one. Below in K4 we can see two vertical adjacent QZ, three AU or UAs, one triple JS (Jim Sanborn), and of course (with the benefit of hindsight from K2 plain text) the anchor points on the upper pyramid WW, which makes the appearance of JFK (John F. Kennedy) and JKL (John Kennedy **Lancer**, which was his Secret Service Cryptonym) extra interesting directly adjacent to the triple JS, linked to each other and to DUL. In the next "shaped" message we will see the "triple JS" points directly at the W in AWDUL. The signal to develop this double pyramid came from the following K4 segments:

KZZWATJKLUDI followed later by **KZXTJCDI**. So the digraphs KZ TJ and DI repeat with inter-digraph distance shrinking from 3 to 1. In transposition analysis, this is an indicator that a diamond/pyramid shape is used to run the transposition. So that can be a great clue to put in a puzzle like this. And this message provides an interesting hint concerning Kryptos. **K2: Who knows the exact location? Only WW.**

						O						
			→		B	K	R					
			←	G	O	X	O	U				
			H	U	L	B	S	O	L			
		V	R	L	F	W	B	B	F	I		
	Q	Q	P	R	N	G	K	S	S	O	T	
W	Z	Z	K	E	S	S	Q	J	S	Q	T	W
F	N	I	W	A	I	D	U	L	K	J	T	A
	B	N	Y	P	V	T	T	M	Z	F	P	
		J	T	X	Z	K	D	G	W	K		
			C	D	I	G	K	U	H			
				K	E	U	A	U	→			
					C	A	R	←				
						?						

Q-codes QSJ QSS appear in both horizontal and vertical planes

Here additional players are drawn into the drama via the same mechanisms. The 7 7 (10) 14 doublets invite to shape the text in those directions. Note that it is necessary to make the ? part of K4 for these arrangements to work, just like it was necessary to make the diamond (or double inverted pyramid) work. This is probably what accounts for the ambiguity Ed Scheidt and Jim Sanborn cultivated around the question mark. Is it part of K3? Yes. Is it part of K4? Yes and no. Thus the ambiguity. It is part of those K4 clandestine messages that use shaped text arrangements. It is not part of the Aryabhata Cipher.

In the 7x14 array, JS is back but this time as the point in an OSS spearhead pointing to W and ADUL (Allen Welsh Dulles). Allen Dulles was in the OSS during World War II. Later he became the head of the CIA. He was fired over various CIA Cuba fiascos, particularly the Bay of Pigs, by President John F. Kennedy. Shortly afterwards he became a very influential, and the only full time, member of the Warren Commission, perhaps also the intended for the W in this array. There is also a double LO, an OSW and a VIG O to ponder (refers to next to Extra L. on the Vigenere). And you can again see A DUL and JKL(ancer) linking up in the L.

Cryptographic tradecraft is also delivered via this array. An important example is spelled vertically in the middle column: CUT (K) VIK. This goes along with the vertical ADD in the left most column. It is an instruction to perform a so called VIC cut in the message. To cut it in the middle and ADD the back half to the front. The message is in the second half. The CUT VIK is in the middle column and the ADD is in the front. This refers to the intersection between the multiple-of-three series and 7squared series. The two sides are also labeled B and A via top row signals, perhaps best seen on the cobra and mongoose graph. The VIC cipher was used by the KGB in the 1950s, notably by Reino Hayhanen. It was never solved until he explained how it worked.

OSS message on simultaneous vertical and horizontal Q-codes

"Shape to XY. If they repeat adjacent, pay attention."

A. W. Dul(les)



?	R	A	C	K	E	U
A	U	H	U	K	G	I
D	C	J	T	X	Z	K
D	G	W	K	P	F	Z
M	T	T	V	P	Y	N
B	F	N	I	W	A	I
D	U	L	K	J	T	A
W	Z	Z	K	E	S	S
Q	J	S	Q	T	W	T
O	S	S	K	G	N	R
P	Q	Q	V	R	L	V
W	B	B	F	I	L	O
S	B	L	U	H	G	O
X	O	U	R	K	B	O

Nice way to shape the OSS spearhead bends with the Qs

Forwards and backwards, left and right, horizontal, vertical, diagonal. A key K4 message

Maybe there is more? Sure wonder about that vertical YAT, too. Hmm, literary connotations perhaps? Either way, Hats off to Edward Scheidt I'd say. Better make another Headline Puzzle in his honor

Headline Puzzle: Axel Rubic!

1. QFU BVMH VOUZ

2. BWQ ZOGX HOF XRKRXQX OGX HRBWAYB O PZYQ

3. HRY HD YLHXC BHXY ECMWECX NHXC W BCKCVE HD YLC XHNMCNCN *ACNBGV, DGNXY VWAC *CE

4. QI APK FQDZBT QI E VHEW

5. LFP ZQ RTJ EBZKP ZQ KLVEJP AZBJK